

Assessment accommodations for English learners with disabilities: What do we know and what do we need to know?

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IDEAs that Work
U.S. Office of Special Education Programs

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Annual Statewide Assessments (Every Student Succeeds Act)

- **Reading/Language Arts and Mathematics in grades 3-8 and high school**
- **Science once in each grade span**
- **English language proficiency for all English learners (ELs) in grades K-12**

Past: Accommodations for Students with Disabilities… and English Learners

"Practices and procedures in the areas of presentation, response, setting, and timing/scheduling that provide equitable access during instructions and assessments for students with disabilities "

Council of Chief State School Officers Accommodations Manual (2005)

Examples from one state

Students with disabilities

- Alternative responses (e.g., signing)
- Extra time
- Adaptive devices
- Human read aloud
- Auditory amplification device
- Braille

English learners

- Audio CD in English (not for reading)
- Small group or individual administration
- Familiar test examiner
- Written version of test directions in English or native language
- Word-to-word bilingual dictionary

Considerations when Selecting Accommodations for ELs/ELs with disabilities:

(1) **Effectiveness** in making an assessment more accessible

(2) **Validity:** should not alter the focal construct

(3) **Differential Impact:** sensitive to student's background characteristics, and their academic standing

(4) **Relevance:** appropriate for the recipients

(5) **Feasibility:** logistically feasible to implement

(Abedi & Ewers, 2013)

What does the research literature tell us about effectiveness? NOT MUCH

- 2 published studies
  - ✓ Abedi, Kao, Leon, Sullivan, Herman, Pope, Nambiar & Mastergeorge (2008) – segmented text
  - ✓ Lin & Lin (2013) – small group/low distraction environment
- ELs with disabilities only a portion of the samples (30%, 0.63%)

No effect of the accommodations!

Technology-Based Assessments Shift: ACCESSIBILITY for All

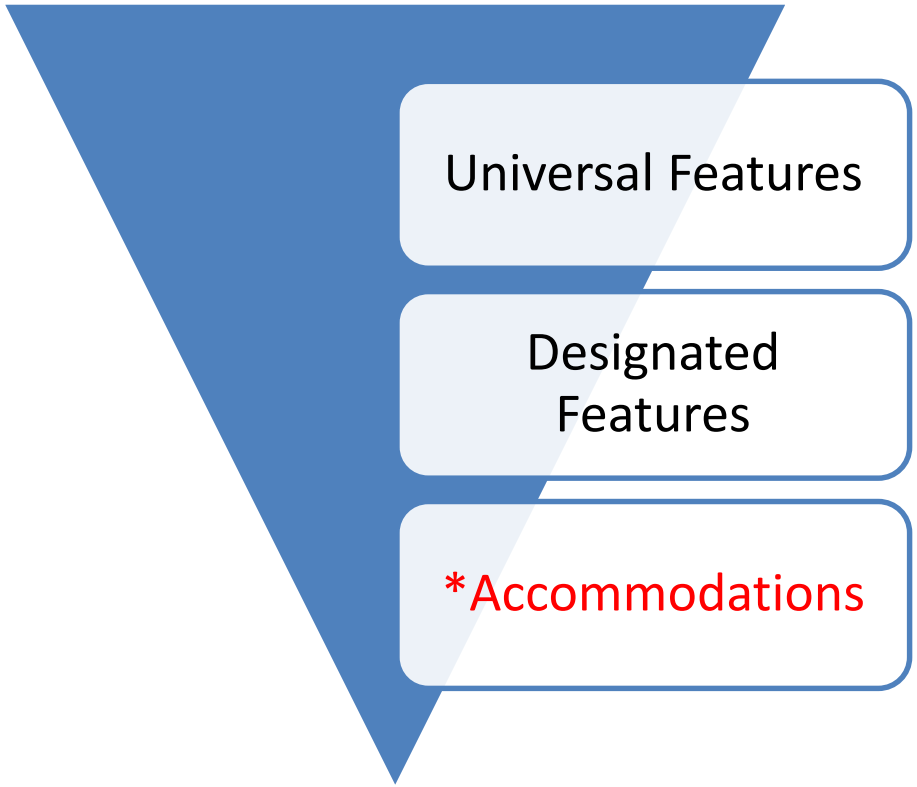


Newer Definition of Accommdations

- **Changes in procedures or materials that ensure equitable access to instructional and assessment content and generate valid assessment results for students who need them.**

(Council of Chief State School Officers, 2016)

Accessibility Features and Accommodations for All Students



What do states allow in policy?

- 31 state policies on accessibility and accommodations currently mention application to ELs with disabilities

- Majority only mention that students may have accommodations for students with disabilities and those for ELs. (Accessibility features are for anyone)

- 1 state breaks out accessibility features and accommodations an EL with a disability may have but not specific to this group

Accessibility Features and Accommodations Can Differ By…

- State
- Test
- Format of test (online vs. paper)
- Subtest
- Grade





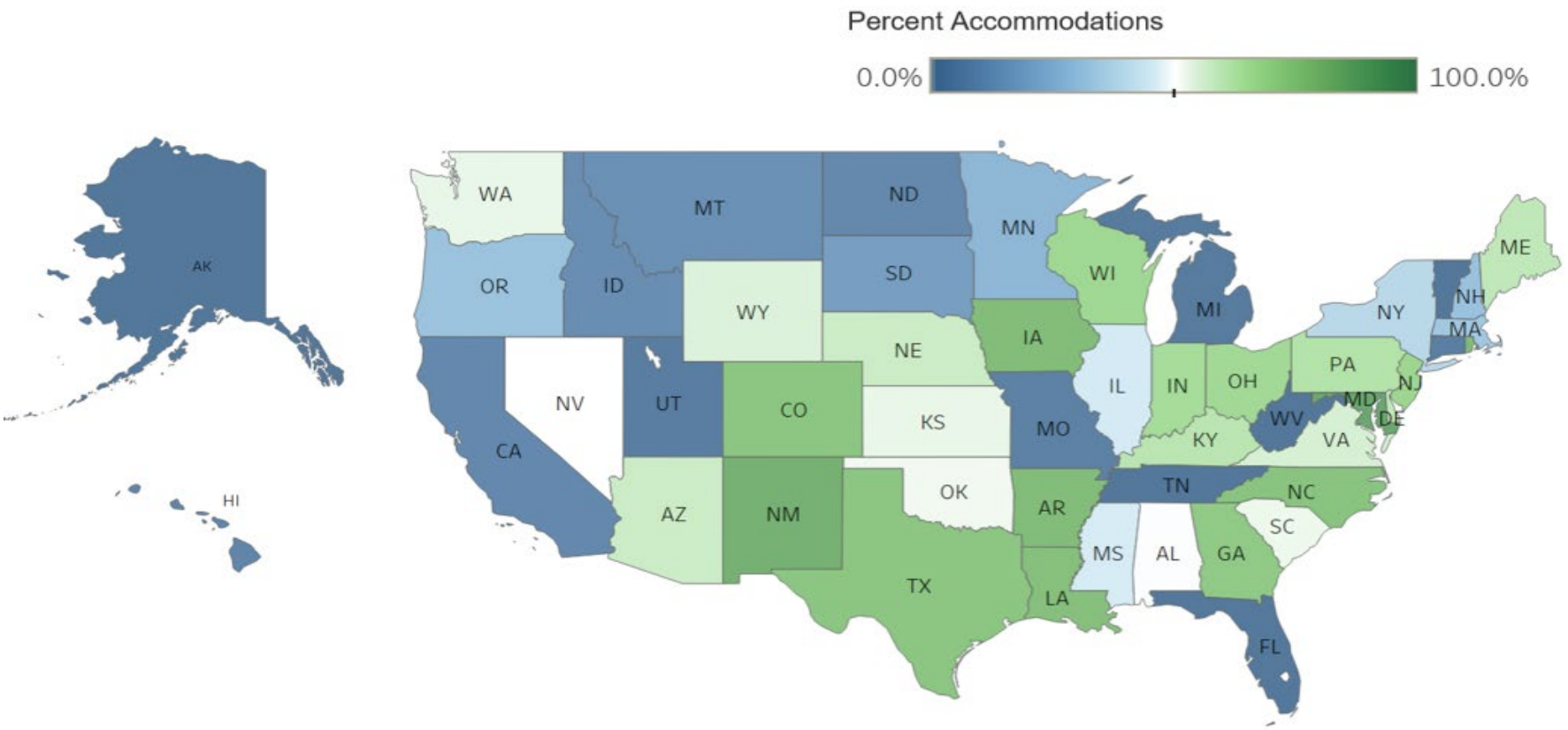
What Data Can Reveal about Accessibility Features and Accommodations Received by Students

Data type

- State-level data
  - Annual performance data
  - State Consolidated report
  - Public reporting
  - % of students with IEPs receiving accommodations
- Student-level data
  - Receiving or not (required)
  - Specific accommodations delivered (received): 29/50 states (2007 state survey)
  - Specific accommodations used
  - Instruction or in the IEP

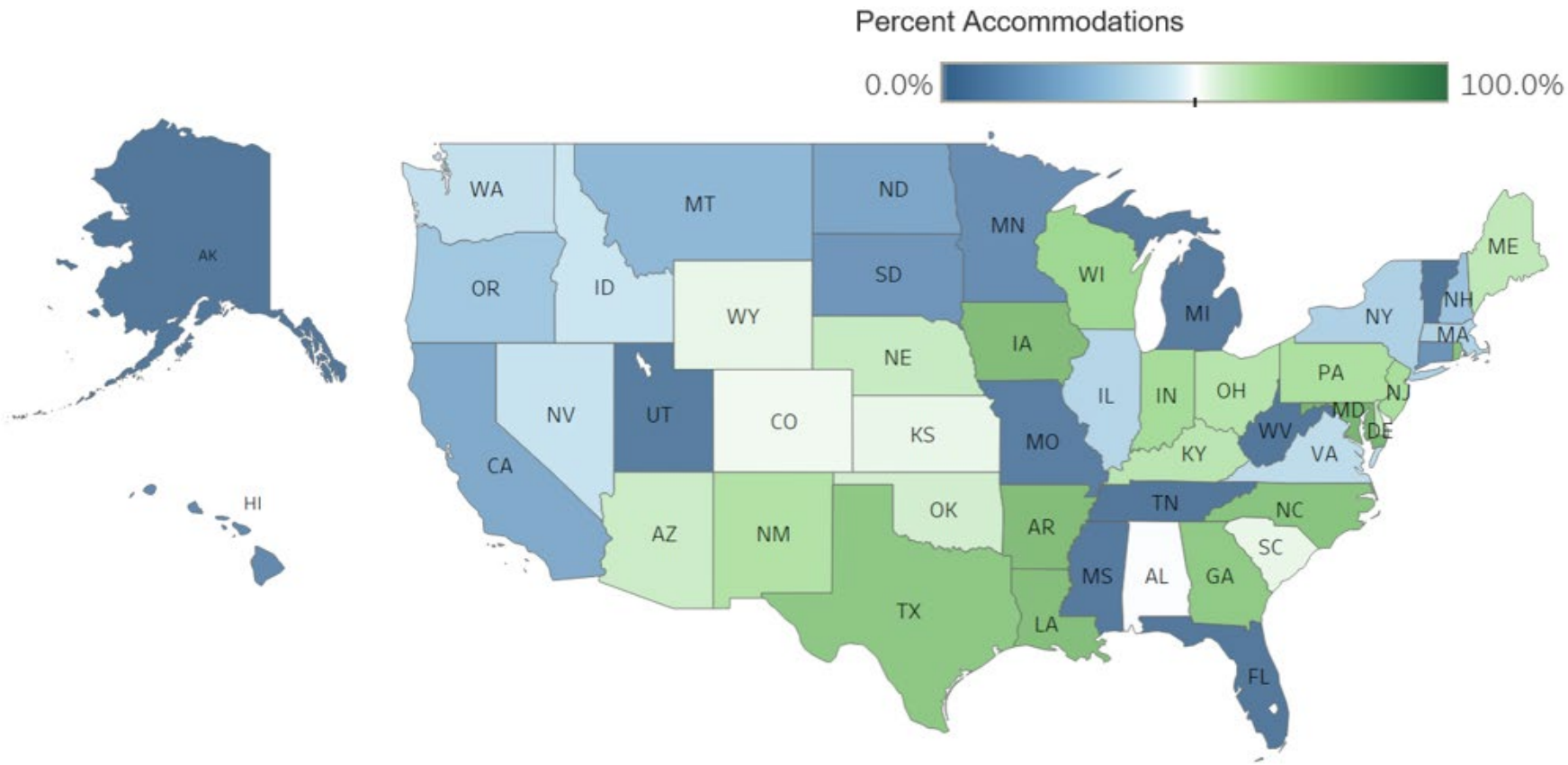
State-Level Data

Map for G3 Math



Resource: Wu, Y. C. (2018, June). *What State Data Can Reveal about Accessibility Features and Accommodations Received by Students* [PowerPoint slides]. Paper presented at the 2018 Annual Conference of National Conference on Student Assessment. San Diego, LA. Retrieved from http://nceo.umn.edu/docs/Presentations/APRACCOMCCSSO.pdf

Map for G3 Reading

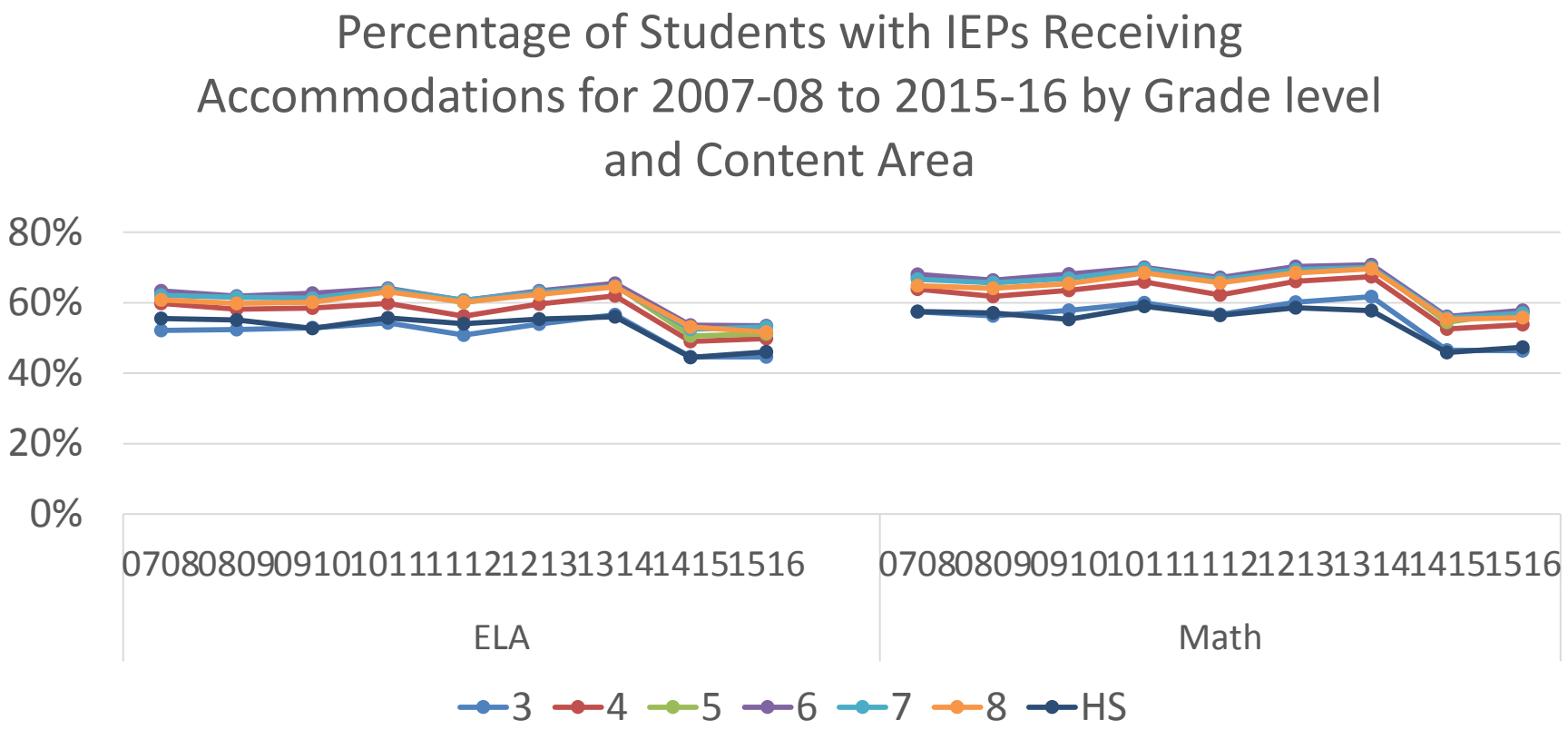


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Maps to Show Changes

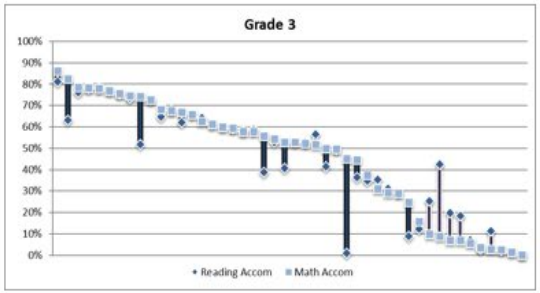
- Trend
  - Trend by year
  - Trend by grade

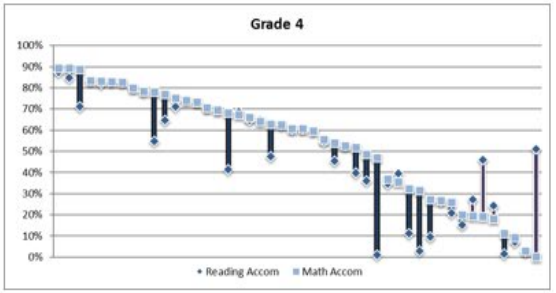
APR-Trend over time

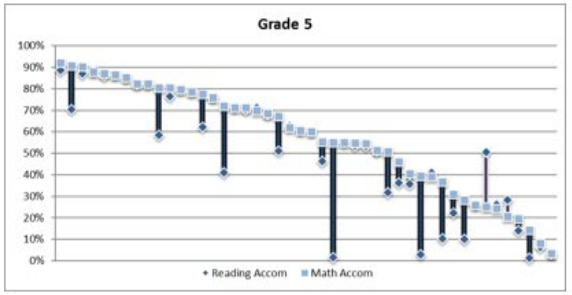


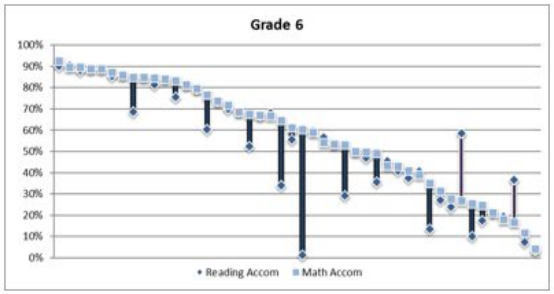
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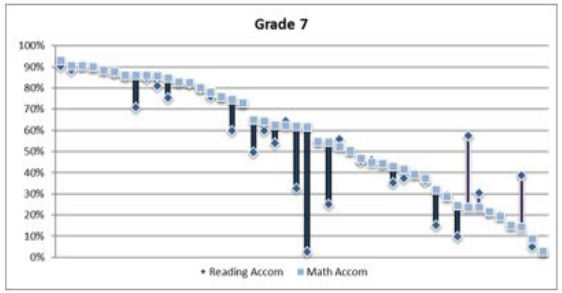
Trends for grade

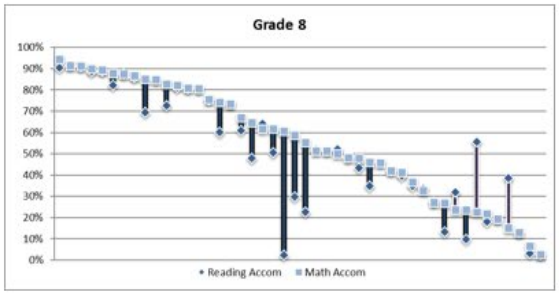


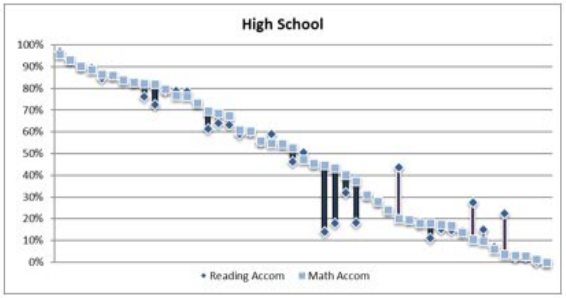








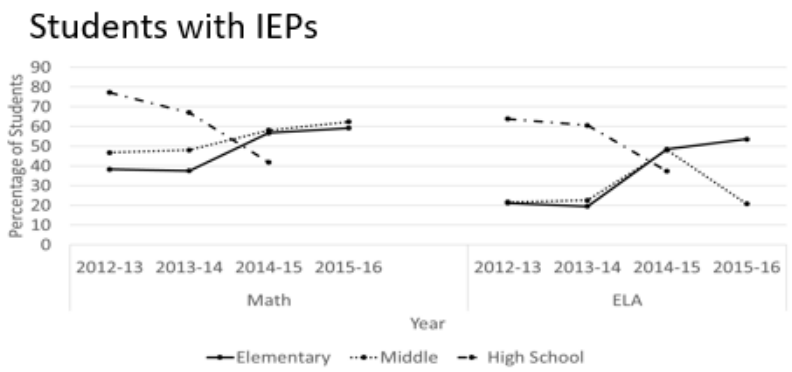


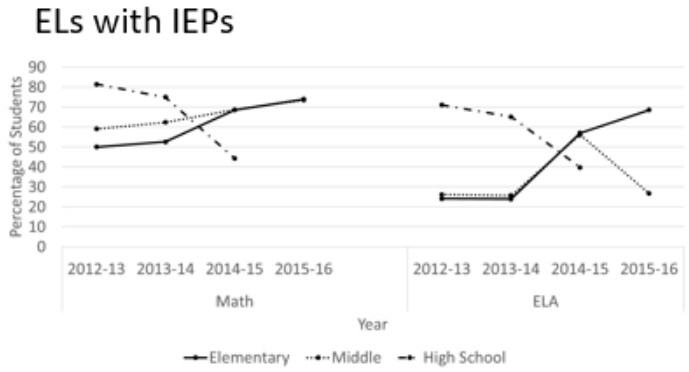


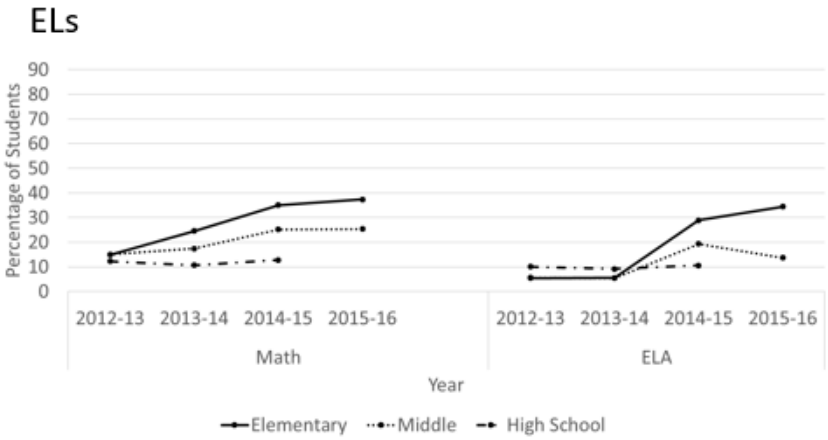
Resource: Wu, Y.-C. , & Thurlow, M. L. (2018). *2015-2016 APR snapshot #17: Students in special education receiving assessment accommodations.* Minneapolis, MN: University of Minnesota, National Center on Educational Outcomes.

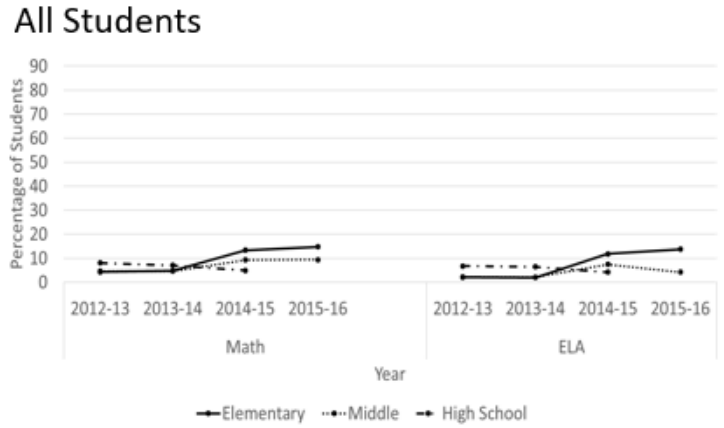
Student-Level Data

Student level --Trend by groups



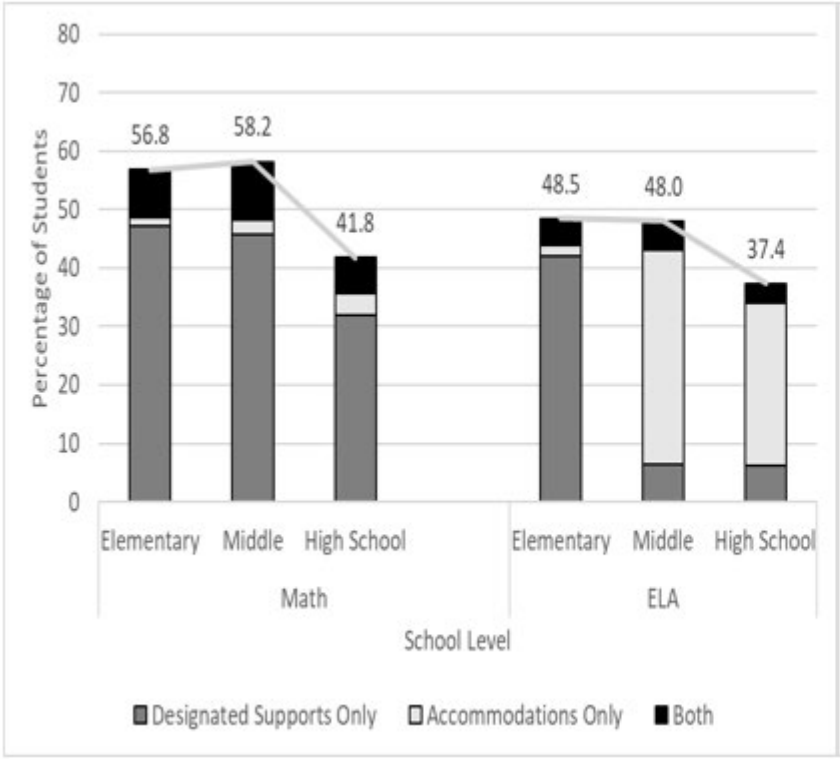


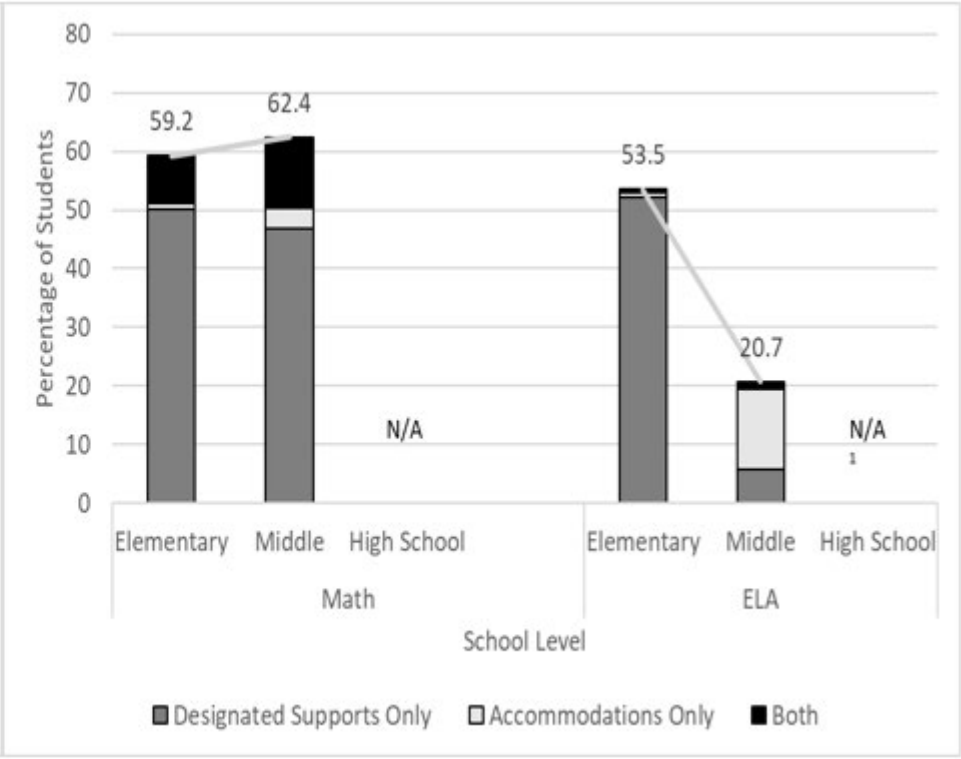




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Distribution of Accommodations and Designated Supports Received—Students with IEPs (14-15 vs. 15-16)

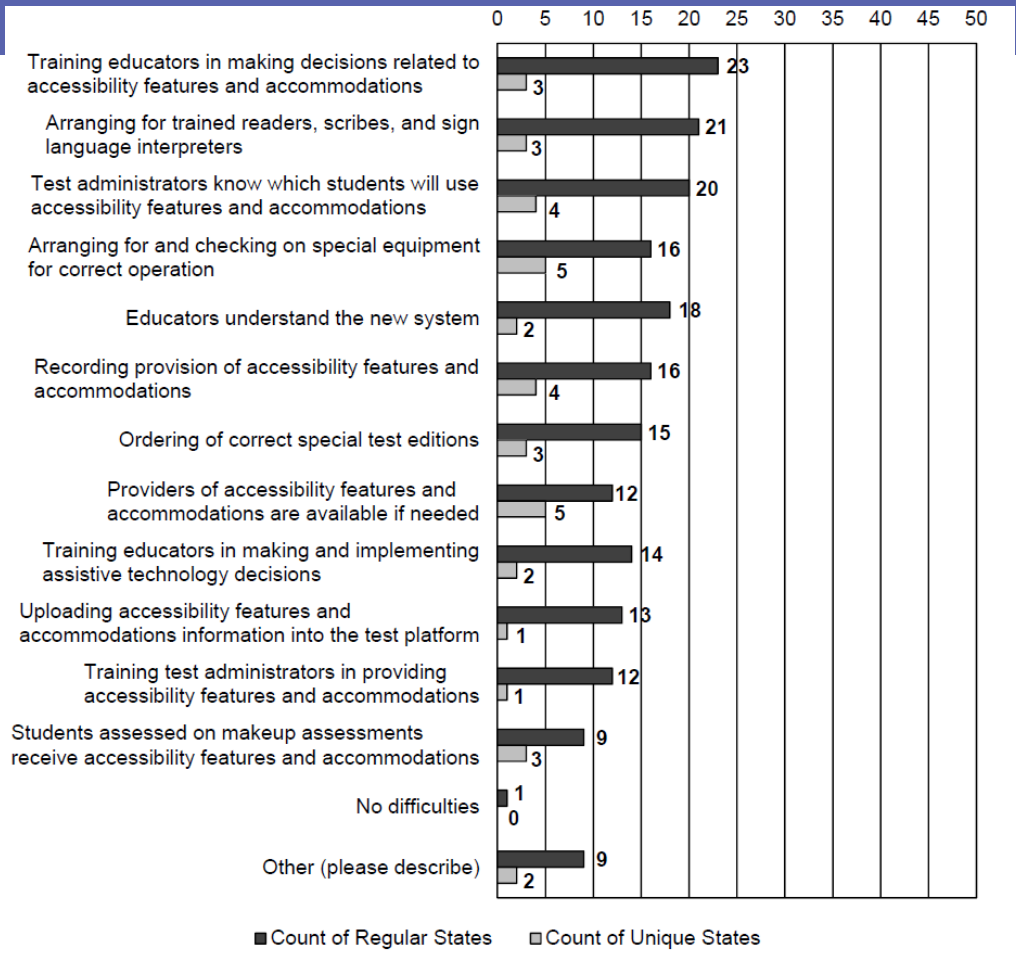




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Challenges in Provision of Accessibility Features and Accommodations

Results are presented for 40 of the 50 regular states and eight of the 11 unique states.



Note. Thirty-eight regular states and eight unique states answered this question. State respondents were able to select multiple responses.

Resource: Thurlow, M. L., Rogers, C., & Lazarus, S. S. (2017). *2016 survey of states: State activities amid evolving educational policies.* Minneapolis, MN: University of Minnesota, National Center on Educational Outcomes.

Challenges Associated with Provisions in ESSA Related to Accommodations

- ELs
  - Ensuring that ELs receive the supports and accommodations to which they are entitled
- ELs with disabilities
  - Ensuring that ELs receive the supports and accommodations to which they are entitled and developing an alternative assessment for the ELP
  - Identification issues around language and disability

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